



THE SISTER NATIONS HAVE GROWN TOGETHER

THE HELSINKI TREATY (1962)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

International law

BEFORE

1814 The integrated state of Denmark–Norway breaks apart, and Norway forms a union with Sweden.

1845 Danish and Swedish students champion the pan-Scandinavian movement, but it collapses in 1864.

1905 The Norway–Sweden union dissolves, and Norway becomes fully independent.

1907 The Nordic Inter-Parliamentary Union of five countries starts holding annual meetings.

AFTER

1996 Norway and Iceland, as members of the Nordic Passport Union, are accepted into the European Schengen Area.

2000 The Øresund Bridge opens, connecting Denmark and Sweden.

Nordic countries are under pressure to form alliances with **powerful blocs** such as NATO and the USSR.

Neutrality in military alignments seems like the **safest option**.

Strengthened by cooperation, Nordic countries can build stable links with **other nations**.

Cooperating with one another is the best way for Nordic countries to **preserve neutrality**.

Created in 1952, the Nordic Council is an assembly of Members of Parliament from each Nordic country: Scandinavia's Norway, Denmark, and Sweden, plus Finland and Iceland. The involvement of active Members of Parliament rather than delegates is unusual in international assembly, and it fosters a rare degree of cooperation. There are 87 MPs in the Nordic Council—20 each from Norway, Sweden, Denmark, and Finland and seven from Iceland. Denmark's total includes two from the Faroe Islands and two from

Greenland; Finland's includes two from the Åland Islands. The Council meets once a year, in fall, with further "theme sessions" held in spring. The assembly is linked to the Nordic Council of Ministers, made up of ministers from each government.

While the ties between the Nordic countries are ancient, the direct impetus for inter-Nordic cooperation was World War II. Both Denmark and Norway were occupied by the Nazis, and Finland was under constant threat from the Soviet Union